

We'll be exploring the ubiquitous options like routers and data cards. Apart from that, we'll also tell you about tricks and techniques you might not have heard of, like pocket routers and tethering gadgets.

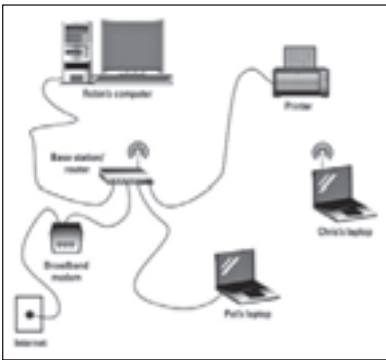
So let's get started:

Using a router for your home

As we've already seen, routers connect networks. We told you in the preceding chapters, that if you want to give all of your computers access to the internet using one modem, you need to use a router or a modem with a built-in router. Routers have a very wide range –from your PC running the good ol' internet sharing software to zillions of dollars' worth of systems of specialised hardware and software.

The router is designed to act as an interface between your local network and the internet and take care of most of the more confusing networking options for you. This in itself is quite a headache –alleviator but routers even go a step further by providing firewall protection between the computers on your network and the rest of the internet.

Physically, the router is situated between your laptop and the internet connection or broadband



Connecting wirelessly to the Router

modem. All computers on the local network connect to this router and not directly to the modem. Routers are configured by logging in to them. The router has an IP address, and you use your web browser software, to connect to the router, log in and set the configurations. We'll now give you a step-by-step guide to connecting and configuring your very own router:

Connecting your router

Although it may seem very daunting technically, setting up a router can be a piece of cake. In fact, after it's set up, you rarely, if ever, have to reconfigure or mess with the router.

Let's take a look at the hardware side of the router. The only connections you have to worry about are situated on the rear. You may refer to the direc-